

Fujifilm FinePix X100

FujiFilm Finepix X100 to launch by March 2011 with an approximate price of Rs. 48,000 (\$1,000); the camera includes a 23mm f/2 fixed lens

Cover feature

The mobile OS game changed forever with the launch of Google's Android. These days, mobile operating systems play an important role in mobile purchasing decisions. Right now we have Android, iOS, Symbian, bada, WinMo and BlackBerry with Windows Phone 7 and MeeGo to arrive soon. So which is the best operating system?

There can't be one answer to that question, as the user experience with each OS is completely different. According to Gartner, as of August 2010, by the numbers Symbian leads with a 41.2 per cent global market share, followed by Research In Motion's 18.2 per cent with Android at third spot with a 17.2 per cent share. In comparison, Apple iOS has a market share of 14.2 per cent. If you compare these market shares with last year's, a surprise winner emerges. Symbian market share has dropped by 10 per cent, whereas Android's share has increased by a whopping 15 per cent. Android is the hot seller right now and it makes sense to purchase a phone having this OS. Frequent updates on the Android OS may keep some users away from it, but anything above Android 1.6 is quite good. You have to be very sure which version of Android your phone will support, whether updating to the newest version is easy. bada is the new kid on the block from Samsung and is presently available on the Samsung Wave.

Applications

One of the main considerations while opting for a smartphone based on its OS, is the number of applications the OS supports. Apple leads with its App Store having over 2,50,000 apps followed by Android's marketplace having over 2,00,000. As compared to these two behemoths, other operating systems have comparatively lesser apps, which is another factor pushing people



Android Mascot

towards the iPhones and Android based phones. bada being relatively new, still has a lot of catching up to do as far as number of applications go. With time the applications segment will just grow. With MeeGo and Windows Phone 7 OS coming up, it will be party time for app developers with so many operating systems, for which apps can be written.

THE HYPE: Dual SIM entry-level phones

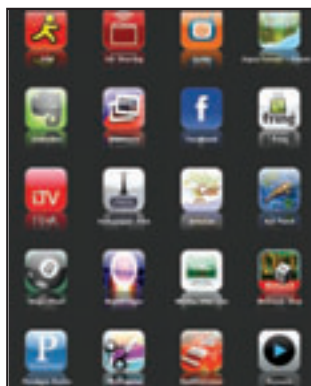
The entry level dual-SIM market in India is exploding at an unprecedented rate. These phones come in a range of form factors and pretty much most of the phones come with the same feature-set that high-end phones from big manufacturers usually ship with. Quality, however, is questionable at times. If you're looking for a phone that can play music, take OK pictures and video and is priced at under ₹5,000, you may find these phones irresistible.

Companies such as Micromax, Karbonn, Lava among others who comprise the *crème de la crème* of the entry-level dual-SIM market have a combined market share of 14 per cent according to a Voice and Data survey.

But before hurrying up to book that dual-SIM phone, sit back and ponder on these points: Am I really going to use two separate numbers? What about the cost incurred on two separate phone plans?

Dual SIMs make sense for individuals who travel a lot. Say for instance, you are working in Delhi, but your hometown is in Hyderabad. Also your work

requires you to be in these cities for longer durations. Then having a Delhi SIM and a Hyderabad SIM in one phone makes sense as you will be able to receive calls from both regions and won't have to carry two phones or keep switching SIMs. Also dual-SIM phones make sense for individuals who plan to have two separate numbers for personal and office use.



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